

HIGH SCHOOLS

WRESTLING

Bears pull off one big upset but drop match to Mustangs

By PAT GALBINEA
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

Every three or four years, North Royalton wrestlers have been able to do something few other teams have been able to accomplish — beat Strongsville in a dual meet.

Last night was not one of those times as the host Bears lost to the perennial Pioneer Conference power, 46-15.

Instead, the Bears had to settle for sophomore Chuck Pedro (112) scoring one of the biggest upsets in the state. Pedro shocked previously unbeaten Mustangs sophomore Nino Paglia, fifth in the state last season, 10-9.

Paglia, who usually wrestles at 103, led, 6-2, in the second period after getting back points with a tilt.

For the remainder of the match, Paglia had trouble riding Pedro. Official Craig Heidinger penalized Paglia twice for stalling.

With 1:21 left in the match, Paglia still led, 8-5, after a double-leg takedown.

Pedro escaped, then went to work on his feet by spinning behind Paglia twice for takedowns — the last coming with 40 seconds left.

Pedro used a cross body to rattle Paglia out and win.

"Last year, Nino pinned me," Pedro said. "This time, all I was

#10 STRONGSVILLE 46
#25 NORTH ROYALTON 15

trying to do was earn his respect. But when I took him down in the last period, I knew I could beat him.

"I've been working hard in practice to become a better wrestler, but so much of this sport is mental, too."

The Mustangs, 10-0 in dual meets and ranked No. 10 in The Plain Dealer Top 25, struggled to win four of the first five matches against the No. 25 Bears (8-4).

Strongsville's lone clear-cut winner was senior Jay Januszewski (125), who pinned sophomore Matt Franko in a cradle at 1:45.

Januszewski had been wrestling at 130 until last night. At the Brecksville Tournament, he gave Columbus DeSales state champion C.P. Schlatter a good match before losing.

One of the Mustangs' better juniors, Brad White (130), barely edged senior Frank D'Amico, 5-4.

White had a 4-0 lead in the second period, but two D'Amico reversals tied the match, 4-4. White won the match with an escape at the final buzzer.

Even Mustangs state qualifier Frank Passafiume (119) got an unexpected turnout from Bears junior Chris Mohrsky before winning, 9-4.

HOCKEY

Eagles hold off rival Wildcats to take penalty-marred battle

By BRANSON WRIGHT
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

Bob Whidden thought he had seen everything in high school hockey — until last night.

"This is as tough as I've seen it between two schools," said St. Edward coach Whidden. "There was cross-checking and high-sticking. There was a lot of emotion out there. I'm not happy with the fighting or with our retaliation."

The "Holy War" between St. Edward and St. Ignatius resulted in six ejections because of misconduct in a game so intense that neither team participated in post-game handshakes.

Meanwhile, St. Edward rallied behind two second-period goals and held on for a 4-3 victory over St. Ignatius at Winterhurst.

The Eagles (14-8, 5-3 in the Red North Division) won their second straight game. St. Edward outlasted this game losing three of its last five. It was St. Edward's fourth victory against no defeats against a Wildcats team that was on fire. St. Ignatius (10-13, 1-6) had won three straight and six out

of seven before last night.

"We needed this win, especially going into the Baron Cup," said St. Edward forward George Ingalls. "This was a big conference win. We still have two more tough games coming up."

The Eagles got up early when Eric Seifchik rebounded a missed shot and slapped the puck in for a 1-0 first-period lead.

The Wildcats didn't take long to answer as they penetrated the Eagles' side of the ice. The action increased in front of the St. Edward goal as bodies from each team piled on the ice. Somehow, Matt Gackowski found an opening and punched in the loose puck. Minutes later, Wildcats defenseman Andrew Keeney got loose and his quick shot froze the defense as it slid from the left face-off circle to snap the tie for a 2-1 lead with 1:56 left in the period.

Defense ruled the majority of the second period, and so did the rough play. The Eagles tied the

score behind Jason O'Bannon's goal. Ingalls broke the tie 32 seconds later with a slap shot in front of the goal for a 3-2 lead.

"We came out flat during the first period and coach yelled at us before the second," Ingalls said. "We listened and came out flying during the second period."

St. Edward breathed a little easier after its final score gave it a two-goal lead in the third period. The Wildcats pulled within a goal with two minutes left.

"We couldn't afford stupid penalties if we expected to win," said Wildcats coach Scott Pick. "What hurt us is that we didn't take care of our end and they capitalized."

Scoring, however, became secondary during the final 60 seconds. Oral threats were made, fists were thrown and bodies were tossed to the ice during several incidents. Ejections followed.

"We're rivals, but things got out of hand," Ingalls said. "It was really dumb on both teams' part. Now, it's over with."

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LONNIE TIMMONS III / THE PLAIN DEALER

Avon Lake fans celebrate after a layup at the buzzer gave the Shoremen a victory over Olmsted Falls.

ESCAPES
FROM 1-D

Shoremen win at the buzzer

Putting the ball in the hands of two-time All-Ohio senior forward Mike Gansey, Olmsted Falls worked the clock down to 10 seconds before Gansey made his move.

Driving to his left, the 6-5 Gansey attempted a tough, off-balance one-hander that misfired. en-Port, who was a force inside all night, rebounded the ball with six seconds left and, in one motion,

threw a perfect outlet pass to Ingolight, who was breaking free down the middle of the court.

Ingolight beat the defender to the basket and softly laid the ball in from the right side as time ran off the clock.

"I just tried it down there and hoped Brian would get it," said Port, who led the Shoremen with 23 points and 11 rebounds. "All I know right now is that 7-0 in the SWC sounds great."

Gansey, a St. Bonaventure recruit, finished with a game-high 31 points. He had 19 points in the first half, which ended with the Bulldogs leading, 40-38. He scored eight quick points to help his team to a 50-42 lead early in the third quarter. Olmsted Falls, which led, 58-51, entering the fi-

nal eight minutes, also got 14 points and four 3-pointers from junior guard Neal Saluja.

Avon Lake, which shot 60 percent for the game, was sparked in the early going by the long-range shooting of senior guard Justin Booher. Booher, who had 16 points, hit three of his four 3-pointers in the first half.

"I got outcoached, it was as simple as that," said Donahue. "I should have called a timeout with about 20 seconds to go and set up a play that would have had us taking the shot with about three seconds left, instead of six seconds. I feel sorry for our kids. They played their hearts out and we lost because of my stupidity."

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HORSE & HARNESS RACING

HORSE & HARNESS RACING INSIDER

Northfield sets betting mark

By BOB ROBERTS
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

Northfield Park is looking like a million dollars.

By averaging \$1.07 million in daily wagers on its 224 programs last year, the Ohio 8 harness oval made history, becoming the first track in the state to crash the seven-figure handle barrier.

It was the popularity of Northfield's races with bettors across North America that resulted in the unprecedented numbers. All but \$42 million of the \$242 million wagered came off-track. Adding in the money bet at Northfield on outside simulcasts (\$79 million), the track handled \$323 million, making for an all-source wagering gain of 8.9 percent compared to 1999.

"A lot of ingredients are involved in our success," said Northfield General Manager Tom Aldrich. "Our television operations room gives us a great presentation, we offer a schedule that pretty much covers the calendar, our simulcasting director [Dave Blanton] is hard-working, and, most of all, our horsemen consistently offer a competitive racing program."

NORTHFIELD REPORT — Brock Milstein, 24, who succeeded his late father, Carl Milstein, as track chairman, was elected to the board of directors of the United States Trotting Association last Saturday. Milstein replaces Aldrich, who has been a member of the USTA board since 1989.

Meanwhile, the Ohio chapter of the U.S. Harness Writers Association has nominated Aldrich for the William R. Haughton Good

Guy Award, given to "a person in the sport who is deemed most co-operative with members of the media" and "whose conduct always reflects credit on himself and harness racing." The Ohio writers also nominated longtime Cleveland Press harness writer Phil Hartman to the Writers Corner of the Harness Racing Hall of Fame. ... Vonda Ward, part-time group sales employee and the daughter of trainer and group sales employee Roseanne Ward, fights for the first women's heavyweight boxing title Feb. 2 in Columbus. A fan bus is being made available and \$50 packages include fight tickets and a tailgate reception. For more information, call 330-467-4101, ext. 203. ... Lebanon shipper Moscow Nights and regular driver Elliott Deaton won for the sixth consecutive time when they captured Monday's featured \$8,500 open trot by a head over Doc Mistake in 2:01.2 over a track rated "good."

WINNERS' CIRCLE — Unbeaten freshman trotting filly Cynthia Iliad was recently named Ohio Horse of the Year. The daughter of Armbrist Iliad is trained by co-owner Don Boroff and driven by Northfield regular David Hawk. Cynthia Iliad won the Buckeye Triple Crown last year, capturing the \$100,000 Ohio Sires Stakes final at Scioto Downs in 1:59.2/5, a \$41,915 Ohio Breeders Championship division in 2:01 at Delaware, Ohio, and a \$25,000 Ohio State Fair Stakes division in 2:01 at Scioto Downs.

THISTLEDOWN UPDATE — Thistle-down, which shares the Northfield, Ohio market with Northfield,

struggled with short fields in 2000. As a result, the recently released all-source handle of \$225 million shows a 4.9 percent drop from 1999. ... Owner Frank Stronach has decided to place his seven tracks back into the National Thoroughbred Racing Association. What this means to fans is that major races at Stronach tracks, like the Florida Derby at Gulfstream Park and the Santa Anita Derby at Santa Anita, will remain on national television, and horseplayers who frequent his tracks will continue to participate in the NTRA's national handicapping contest. ... Andrew Konkoly's Governors Ego, who campaigned at Thistle-down last year and won seven races, shared the "winningest horse in North America" title with Difficult Doll. Each had 12 victories.

HAPPY NEW YEAR AT BEULAH PARK — The suburban Columbus track got 2001 off to a fast start when a common pleas court in Franklin County ruled last week that it can continue to operate its online wagering service, Winticket.com. Beulah took the Ohio State Racing Commission to court over the issue after the OSRC tried to shut down the Internet site. Although the commission approved Winticket.com in January of last year, Ohio Attorney General Betty Montgomery told the OSRC to "terminate the experimental operation and completed formal opinion could be issued." Charles Roma, Beulah's president, challenged the order and won.

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NORTHFIELD TONIGHT'S ENTRIES

PP	Horse	Last 3 starts	Driver	Odds
1	Strong Scott	5-6-7	D Ward	7-2
2	Pisano	3-5-5	J Pansano	9-2
3	Rockwell Club	3-5-5	R Thoms	12-1
4	End Zone Goal	7-2-4	W Inve	12-1
5	Mojo Hanger	4-5-1	G Grims	15-1
6	Honey Tugan	2-6-7	B Miler	3-1
7	My Guy	5-5-5	W Case Jr	6-1
8	Al Buge	7-6-4	W Case Jr	6-1
9	Wendy Fox	2-6-6	Schiao	5-2

PP	Horse	Last 3 starts	Driver	Odds
1	Home Free Burn	6-7-1	W Case Jr	5-2
2	Rockwell Club	1-3-3	R Thoms	12-1
3	Indiana Jack	2-5-5	B Miler	7-2
4	Mojo Hanger	4-5-1	G Grims	15-1
5	My Guy	5-5-5	W Case Jr	6-1
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POST TIME

Plain Dealer handicapper Bob "Railbird" Roberts, with \$1,000 of company funds tucked in his Racing Forms and track programs, is taking on the pari-mutuel world — 24 hours a day. Not only is he betting the races at Northfield, but simulcasts from tracks around the clock and globe.

TODAY'S PLAYS — Open in the second race at Gulfstream Park by taking My Guy Norman first and second to all 10 rivals with \$1 exacta tickets.

Close in the 10th at Gulfstream with \$10 to win on Songandaprayer. Total wagers: \$30.

24-HOUR BANKROLL UPDATE — The Railbird hopes working a double shift pays off. "I bet and lost \$20 yesterday afternoon, but I had late night action at Mountaineer and Northfield Park," said Roberts. "Light a candle and hope